



Bank Alfalah

ALFA LEAD
ASSESSMENT
CENTER



THE BANK ALFALAH
EXPERIENCE
CENTER

THE BANK ALFALAH EXPERIENCE CENTER

Prototype Challenge

The Brief

Bank Alfalah wants to reimagine what a branch of the future looks like. Not a branch — an **Experience Center**: a single physical space where any customer — a student opening their first account, a business owner applying for a loan, a retiree managing their savings, a family buying their first home — can walk in and have every banking need met in one visit, with an experience that feels **more like a flagship store than a bank**. But beyond design, Bank Alfalah now has one critical question: Is this even feasible as a scalable, profitable banking model?

Your team has been hired to design this space. You will physically build a scaled-down model of your Experience Center using the materials provided, AND evaluate whether it can realistically work in the real world. At the end, you will pitch your design to the Bank Alfalah leadership team as if you are presenting to the CEO.

What Your Model Must Include

Your physical prototype must clearly show the following five zones:

1. The Welcome Zone — First 30 Seconds

- How does a customer feel the moment they walk in? What do they see, hear, and experience?
- Think: digital welcome screen that recognizes returning customers, greeter with a tablet, ambient branding, accessibility features for all customers.

2. The Self-Service Hub — Instant Banking

- A zone where customers can handle routine transactions without waiting in a queue.
- Think: smart ATMs/CDMs, account opening kiosks (CNIC-based, 3-minute process), Raast transfers, bill payments, card issuance on the spot.

3. The Advisory Lounge — Conversations, Not Counters

- A space where customers sit with a relationship manager for complex needs — loans, investments, insurance, business banking.
- Think: private consultation pods (not open desks), screens showing the customer's portfolio, digital document signing, family-friendly options.

4. The Digital Experience Wall — Wow Factor

- An interactive zone that showcases Bank Alfalah's digital products: the Alfa app, Alfa Business, Roshan Digital Accounts, investment tools.
- Think: touchscreens where customers can explore products, a live demo station, QR codes linking to app features, an AI financial health checker.

The Feasibility and Operational Model

Your team must now design a Feasibility Layer answering the following:

1. Financial Feasibility

- What would it cost to build 1 Experience Center?
- What would monthly operating costs look like?
- What revenue streams justify it?

2. Customer Feasibility

- Who will actually use this?
- Which segments benefit most vs least?
- Will traditional banking customers adopt it?

3. Operational Feasibility

- Staff required per shift
- Training needs (especially for hybrid advisory roles)
- Technology dependency risks
- Peak-hour handling strategy

4. Scalability Logic

- Can this be replicated across Pakistan?
- How would the design change between a major city (e.g. Karachi, Lahore) and a smaller city (e.g. Sukkur, Abbottabad)?
- Standardized vs customizable elements

Materials Provided

Item	Could Be Used For	Cost
Cardboard sheets (large)	Base, walls, partitions	PKR 200 each
Colored paper (A4 pack)	Branding, zone markers, signage	PKR 25 per sheet
Sticky notes (pack)	Labels, annotations, customer personas	PKR 100 per pack
Markers & pens	Drawing, labeling, flow arrows	Free
Straws / wooden sticks	Structures, kiosk models, partitions	PKR 50 per bundle
String / yarn	Customer flow paths	PKR 50 per roll
Bottle caps	Kiosks, ATMs, seating markers	PKR 40 each
Clay / playdough	People, counters, 3D elements	PKR 150 per pack
Tape / glue stick / scissors	Assembly	PKR 100 each
★ LED string light	Ambiance, digital wall effect	PKR 500 (premium)
★ Printed Bank Alfalah logos	Branding, signage, realism	PKR 300 (premium)
★ Transparent sheets	Glass wall effect, screen mockups	PKR 400 (premium)

Timeline

Phase	Duration	What Happens
Individual Reading	3 min	Read this document. Ask questions. Clarify anything you don't understand.
Strategy & Planning	7 min	Discuss your concept as a team. Decide zones, flow, material purchases, and who does what. Sketch your layout before you build.
Build + Feasibility Design	28 min	Build your physical model AND develop your feasibility logic (on paper/chart sheet) simultaneously. Divide labor.
Final Pitch	12 min	Each team presents their Experience Center to the assessors. Walk us through the customer journey: "Imagine you are a customer walking into our Bank Alfalah Experience Center..." Show both the physical and operational model.

REMEMBER

You are not just building a model — you are designing an experience.

Think about what makes people choose one bank over another. It's not the interest rate. It's how the bank makes them feel.

The best Experience Center is the one that makes a customer say: "I want to come back here."

Good luck. Build something worth visiting.

FEASIBILITY CHEAT SHEET

Quick reference to help you think about practical numbers & real-world considerations

TIER 1 vs TIER 2 CITIES



TIER 1

Karachi, Lahore, Islamabad /
Rawalpindi, Faisalabad, Multan

Higher footfall, higher rent, tech-savvy customers, more competition



TIER 2

Hyderabad, Peshawar, Quetta,
Sialkot, Gujranwala, Sukkur,
Abbottabad, Mardan, Bahawalpur

Lower rent, traditional customers, fewer digital users, strong community ties



SAMPLE COST BENCHMARKS

Cost Category	Tier 1 Estimate	Tier 2 Estimate
 Monthly rent (2,000–3,000 sq ft)	PKR 800K – 1.5M	PKR 200K – 500K
 One-time fit-out & construction	PKR 15M – 30M	PKR 8M – 15M
 Technology (kiosks, screens, systems)	PKR 8M – 15M	PKR 5M – 10M
 Monthly salaries (8–12 staff)	PKR 1.5M – 2.5M	PKR 800K – 1.5M
 Monthly utilities & maintenance	PKR 300K – 500K	PKR 150K – 300K



POTENTIAL REVENUE STREAMS

 Deposits Current accounts, savings, fixed deposits from walk-in customers	 Lending Personal loans, auto loans, home finance, credit cards	 Fee Income Account fees, remittance charges, locker rentals, card charges
 Insurance & Investments Bancassurance, mutual funds, Naya Pakistan Certificates	 Digital Adoption Alfa app activations driving transaction volume, lower branch costs	 SME & Business Trade finance, business accounts, merchant acquiring (POS/QR)

TYPICAL FLOOR LAYOUT (2,500 sq ft reference)

	Welcome Zone	200–300 sq ft	Entrance, greeter, digital screen, queue management
	Self-Service Hub	400–500 sq ft	3–4 kiosks/ATMs, account opening, bill payments
	Advisory Lounge	600–800 sq ft	3–4 private pods, RM desks, document signing
	Digital Experience Wall	200–300 sq ft	Interactive screens, demo station, product showcase
	Back Office & Utilities	400–500 sq ft	Staff area, server room, storage, washrooms

SAMPLE STAFFING PER SHIFT

Total per shift: **9–10 staff**

	Branch Manager / Center Lead	1	<i>Oversight</i>
	Welcome Zone Host / Greeter	1	<i>Welcome Zone</i>
	Self-Service Assistants	2	<i>Self-Service Hub</i>
	Relationship Managers	2–3	<i>Advisory Lounge</i>
	Digital Experience Guide	1	<i>Digital Wall</i>
	Operations / Cash Officer	1	<i>Back Office</i>
	Security Guard	1	<i>Entrance</i>



Use these numbers as a starting point. Your team should build its own assumptions and be ready to justify them during the pitch. **The best feasibility model is the one that shows you've thought about the real world.**